



THE UTILITY MITT

by Kea2 Knits



Sample shown in size small
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PATTERN INFORMATION

An extremely practical, deceptively simple flip-top mitten that will keep your hands warm while you text your friends. Invisible flip-top seam. Unisex. Available in 5 sizes from young teen to grown man.

Difficulty: Intermediate. Due to the somewhat unusual construction method and general fiddliness, prior experience with knitting in the round is helpful. Techniques include knitting in the round, increases, decreases, and mid-row cable cast-on.

Yarn: Self-stripping or solid coloured sock weight yarn in wool, wool blend or acrylic. Cotton and other non-stretchy fibres not recommended. Sample (see cover) knitted in Filatura Di Crosa Maxime Print.

Yardage: 170 to 340 metres or 186 to 372 yards. (One or two 50g balls depending on size).

Gauge: 30 st and 41 rounds per 10 cm/4 in square in stockinette worked in the round

Equipment: Double-pointed or circular 2.5 mm/US size 1 1/2 knitting needles for main part of mitten, 2.75 mm/US size 2 for fingers & thumb. 4 stitch holders. 2 stitch markers. Scrap yarn.

Abbreviations

Sts: Stitches

K: Knit

P: Purl

YO: Yarn over

K1tbl: Knit 1 through back loop

M1: Make one stitch by picking up, twisting and knitting the loop between the stitches of the previous row.

[...] : Repeat the directions between the square brackets the number of times specified.

Sizing

Choose your size based on your hand circumference as measured around the knuckles. The chart is based on average proportions. If your hand or fingers are longer or shorter than indicated, you can adjust the length of the glove at the points indicated in the “Note” boxes. Stitch and row counts for the sizes are written in XS (S, M, L, XL) format.

Size	XS	S	M	L	XL
Circumference around knuckles (excluding thumb)	15 cm 6 in	17 cm 6 3/4 in	19 cm 7 1/2 in	21 cm 8 1/4 in	23 cm 9 in
Length of hand (wrist joint to tip of middle finger)	15.5 cm 6 1/8 in	16.5 cm 6.1/2 in	17.5 cm 7 7/8 in	18.5 cm 7 1/4 in	19.5 cm 7 5/8 in
Length of palm (wrist joint to knuckle joint)	8.5 cm 3 3/8 in	9 cm 3 1/2 in	10 cm 4 in	10.5 cm 4 1/8 in	11 cm 4.3/8 in
Length of thumb	4.5 cm 1 3/4 in	5 cm 2 in	5.4 cm 2 1/8 in	5.7 cm 2 1/4 in	6 cm 2 3/8 in

RIGHT MITTEN

Cuff

Cast on 42, (48, 54, 60, 64) sts on 2.5 mm/US size 1 1/2 circular or double-pointed needles. Join without twisting. Work in [k1, p1] ribbing for 21 (24, 27, 30, 32) rounds.

Thumb gusset

Round 1: Insert stitch marker, yo, insert 2nd stitch marker, k to end.

Round 2: Slip marker, k1tbl, slip marker, k to end.

Round 3: K all.

Round 4: Slip marker, yo, k up to next marker, yo, slip marker, k to end of round.

Round 5: Slip marker, k1tbl, k to 1 st before next marker, k1tbl, slip marker, k to end of round.

Round 6: k all

Repeat rounds 4-6 until you have 15 (17, 17, 19, 21) sts between markers (a total of 24, 27, 27, 30, 33 rounds)

For XS and M sizes only: K 2 more rounds even.

Note:

If needed, you can lengthen the thumb gusset here by working a few more rounds even. Write down how many rounds you add so that you can do the same on the left mitten.

Remove one marker and place thumb stitches on a stitch holder or scrap yarn.

Flip-top seam

The remaining marker indicates the beginning of the round. K 6 (6, 7, 7, 8) rounds even. This should bring you up halfway between the base of the thumb and the top of the palm.

Note:

If needed, you can lengthen or shorten the glove here by adding or subtracting a few rounds.

Starting from the marker, divide the stitches in half for the palm and top of the hand. The palm is where the flip top will open, and the top is where the seam will be.

K the palm half. 21 (24, 27, 30, 32) sts.

On the top half, knit each stitch through both front and back loops, doubling their number. 42 (48, 54, 60, 64) sts. You will see stitches which look like “knit” stitches alternating with ones that look like “purl” stitches.

With the right side of the knitting facing you, carefully slip the “knit” stitches onto a stitch holder held to the front, and the “purl” stitches onto a knitting needle held to the back. You now have two layers of stitches, one on the outside and one on the inside of the mitten. 21 (24, 27, 30, 32) sts each.

Inner mitten

Working with the inner layer (the “purl” sts) of the fliptop seam, k 7 (7, 8, 8, 9) rounds.

Remove the marker and divide the stitches in half for the front and back of the mitten, placing them on 2 separate holders. 21 (24, 27, 30, 32) sts each.

Note:

When joining yarn to knit the fingers, leave a long tail. These can be used later to sew up the holes between the fingers.

Index finger

Switch to 2.75 mm/ US size 2 needles

Starting from the sts closest to the thumb gusset, k6 (7, 8, 8, 9) sts each from the front holder. Cast on 2 sts using cable cast on method. K6 (7, 7, 8, 8) sts from back holder. 14 (16, 17, 18, 19 sts total).

Join yarn and k6 (7, 7, 8, 8) more rounds.

Bind off loosely using [k1, p1] bind-off.

Middle finger

Starting from the sts closest to the index finger, k5, (6, 7, 8, 8) sts from the front holder.

Cast on 2 sts using the cable cast-on method.
K5 (6, 7, 7, 8) sts from the back holder.

Pick up 2 sts from the bottom of the index finger, for a total of 14 (16, 18, 19, 20) sts.

Join yarn and k7 (8, 8, 9, 9) more rounds.

Bind off loosely using [k1, p1] bind-off.

Ring finger

Starting from the sts closest to the middle finger, k the next 5 (5, 6, 7, 7) sts from the front holder.

Cast on 2 sts using the cable cast-on method.
K5, (5, 6, 7, 8) sts from the back holder.

Pick up 2 sts from the bottom of the middle finger, for a total of 14 (14, 16, 18, 19) sts.

Join yarn and k6 (7, 7, 8, 8) more rounds.

Bind off loosely using [k1, p1] bind-off.

Little finger

Starting from the sts closest to the ring finger, k5 (6, 6, 7, 8) sts from the front holder. K5 (6, 7, 8, 8) sts from the back holder.

Pick up 2 sts from the bottom of the ring finger for a total of 12 (14, 15, 17, 18) sts.

Join yarn and k5 (6, 6, 7, 7) more rounds.

Bind off loosely using [k1, p1] bind-off.

Thumb

Pick up the 15 (17, 17, 19, 21) sts from the thumb gusset stitch holder.

Join yarn at the inner edge of the thumb, and knit 7 (8, 9, 9, 9) rounds. This should bring you a bit more than 1/3 of the way up the thumb.

Note:

If needed, you can lengthen or shorten the thumb here by adding or subtracting a few rounds.

Thumb slit:

The thumb slit is a vertical hole on the inner edge of the thumb so that you can slip your thumb out to use your cell phone or handle small change.

Suggestion:

As an alternative to the thumb slit, you can knit the thumb using conductive thread held double with the yarn to make the glove usable on smart phone touch screens.

Row 1: K 15 (17, 17, 19, 21). Do not join to other side of round. Turn work.

Row 2: P (15, 17, 17, 19, 21). Turn work.

Repeat rows 1 and 2 a total of 3 (3, 3, 4, 4) times, for a total of (6, 6, 6, 8, 8 rows worked flat).

On the next round, switch back to working in the round, and k 1 (2, 3, 3, 3) rounds.

Thumb decrease

Round 1: k2tog, k to end of round (14, 16, 16, 18, 20 sts remaining).

Round 2: [k2tog] until end of round (7, 8, 8, 9, 10 sts remaining).

Round 3: k all.

Round 4: If you have an even number of sts, [k2tog] to end of round. If you have an odd number of sts, k1, then [k2tog] to end of round. (4, 4, 4, 5, 5 sts remaining). Cut yarn and thread through remaining sts. Pull tight.

Flip top

Using 2.5 mm/US size 1 needles, pick up and knit the 21 (24, 27, 30, 32) outer layer stitches from the holder. Insert first marker.

Turn work and cast on 21 (24, 27, 30, 32) stitches using the cable cast-on method. Insert second marker, and join new stitches to beginning of round. 42 (48, 54, 60, 64) sts total.

Closure ribbing: [K up to first marker, slip 1st marker, work in [k1, p1] ribbing to second marker (end of round)] for a total of 8, (9, 9, 10, 10) rounds.

Work in stockinette for 15 (15, 16, 16, 16) rounds.

Note:

If needed, you can lengthen or shorten the glove here by adding or subtracting a few rounds.

Decreases:

Set-up round for XL size only: Work 1 round in stockinette, decrease 4 times evenly (60 sts remaining).

Round 1: Work in stockinette, decreasing evenly 6 times.

Round 2: k all

Repeat rounds 1 and 2 until there are only 6 sts remaining. Cut yarn, thread through remaining sts and pull tight.

Suggestion:

The decrease method specified in this pattern is ideal for self-stripping yarn because it makes the stripes decrease in concentric circles like the top of a hat. To prevent a visible spiral from developing, shift your decreases over a few stitches every decrease round.

If you are not using self-stripping yarn, you may choose a different decrease method. For example, you can decrease on either side of each marker (4 decreases per decrease round instead of 6) until the flip top reaches the desired length. Then, graft together the remaining stitches to create a flat top.

LEFT MITTEN

Work the same as the right mitten up to the flip top seam.

Note:

If you lengthened or shortened the right mitten at any point, remember to do the same on the left.

Flip top seam

Insert marker for new beginning of round. K 6 (7, 8, 9, 9) rounds even.

Starting from the BOR marker, divide the stitches in half for the palm and top of the hand. The palm is where the flip top will open, and the top is where the seam will be.

Note:

Make sure the opening is on the opposite side than on the right mitten.

On the top half, knit each stitch through both front and back loops, doubling their number. 42 (48, 54, 60, 64) back sts.

Then, k the palm half. 21 (24, 27, 30, 32) sts.
Pass BOR marker.

On the top of the mitten, you will see stitches which look like “knit” stitches alternating with ones that look like “purl” stitches.

With the right side of the knitting facing you, carefully slip the “knit” stitches onto a stitch holder held to the front, and the “purl” stitches onto a knitting needle held to the back. You now

have two layers of stitches, one on the outside and one on the inside of the mitten. 21 (24, 27, 30, 32) sts each.

Inner mitten

Knit the inner layer of the fliptop seam, then knit the palm half of the mitten.

Knit another 7 (7, 8, 9, 11) rounds.

Divide the stitches in half for the top and palm of the mitten, and place on 2 separate holders. 21 (24, 27, 30, 32) sts each.

Fingers

Divide the stitches for the fingers and work the fingers the same as the right mitten.

Note:

Remember to mirror the right mitten. Place the index finger closest to the thumb gusset.

Thumb

Same as the right mitten.

Flip top

Same as the right mitten.

Finishing

Using the tails of the yarn, sew up any holes between the fingers. Weave in ends.